

The Blue Hour Exposure Ladder

Pocket cheat sheet. Set f/8 · ISO 100 before the light moves, then walk the shutter down as the sky darkens. You are not chasing exposure — you are descending a staircase you built in advance.

THE LADDER — DOUBLE THE SHUTTER ~EVERY 3 MINUTES



Meter the brightest part of the sky at sunset to anchor T+0. Timings are approximate — the sky sets the pace, the ladder keeps you honest.

WHITE BALANCE

4000K honest cobalt

3200K cinematic teal

AWB murders the blue → muddy gray

RAW always — previews tell the truth

SHOOT THE THREE MOMENTS

- ▶ **Early blue** — foreground detail
- ▶ **Mid blue** — the cobalt itself
- ▶ **Late blue** — city as pure signal on black

TRIPOD CONTRACT

- ▶ **2-sec timer** or remote — no finger on the shutter
- ▶ **Stabilization OFF** on the tripod
- ▶ **Weigh it down** — hang your bag

► **Electronic shutter**
(mirrorless, 1–8s range)



Know the exit. When the sky goes black and the foreground turns to mud, the contract has closed.
Pack at the plan's end — operators leave with three deliberate frames.